GGG-C-311C
July 23, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GGG-C-311b
March 17, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHISELS AND GOUGES, WOODWORKING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers woodworkers' chisels, gouges, and slicks normally used by cabinetmakers, patternmakers, and carpenters for carving, paring, turning, shaping, and finishing various wood products.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types, classes, and styles. Chisels, gouges, and slicks shall be of the following types, classes, and styles, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Chisels.
- Class 1 - Framing, socket.
- Class 3 - Butt, bevel edge.
- Class 4 - Firmer.
  - Style A - Bevel edge, wood handle.
  - Style C - Bevel edge, plastic handle.
- Class 8 - Paring, tanged.
  - Style A - Straight shank.
- Class 9 - Turning, tanged.
  - Style A - Square point.
  - Style B - Round point.
  - Style C - Spear point.
  - Style D - Regular skew.

Type II - Gouges.
- Class 1 - Firmer, socket or tang.
  - Style A - Outside bevel.
  - Style B - Inside bevel.
- Class 2 - Turning, tanged.

Type III - Socket slicks (oval back).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-P-40 - Packaging and Packing of Hand Tools.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustrations. The illustrations herein are descriptive and not restrictive, and are not intended to preclude the purchase of chisels, gouges, and slicks which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Handles. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), handles shall be of either hardwood or plastic, well-proportioned, and of suitable size and shape to facilitate a smooth comfortable handgrip. Handles shall be firmly and securely attached to the tang or socket of the chisel to prevent looseness or falling off during usage.

3.2.1 Wood handles. Wood handles for all types of chisels (except type III) shall be made of high quality, straight grained, sound, thoroughly seasoned hickory, hard (sugar) maple, or applewood having not more than 12 percent moisture content. Hickory handles shall have not more than 20 rings of growth per inch of radius. Type III handles shall be made of clear, straight-grained, seasoned hardwood such as maple, ash, hickory, cherry, or birch. All handles shall be free from knots, checks, holes, or any defects that may affect their serviceability.

3.2.1.1 Finish. All exposed surfaces of the wood handle shall be smoothly finished with a transparent, protective, and durable coating of enamel, varnish, shellac, or lacquer to prevent absorption of moisture.

3.2.2 Plastic handles. Plastic handles shall comply with the test requirements specified in 4.4.3. The handles shall be free from cracks, chipped edges or surfaces, blisters, warps, uneven surfaces, dents, heat marks, or any other defects that may affect their appearnace or serviceability. The crown portion at the striking end of the handle shall be either plain or provided with a steel cap. The handles may be plain or colored, at the option of the manufacturer.

3.3 Blades. Blades shall be of high-grade tool steel of uniform quality, free from hard spots, cracks, or other injurious defects. The blades shall be properly heat treated (see 3.3.1) to provide tools capable of long life under ordinary service conditions and of withstanding the tests specified in 4.4. The minimum length of the blade, exclusive of the socket or tang, shall conform to the applicable table and be of a design to provide a cutting edge ground to such a degree as to provide tools suitable for the purpose intended. The blades, socket barrels, and tangs shall be either all of one piece, or of two pieces with the socket barrels securely and invisibly welded to the blade. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), and except for type III socket slicks (see 3.6.1.1), tolerances on blade widths shall be +1/32 or -1/32 inch.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.1 Hardness. The full length of the blade shall be heat treated and tempered. The blade shall be properly hardened to a Rockwell hardness value of not less than 55 nor more than 63 on the C scale (see 4.4.1), not less than 1-1/2 inches from the cutting edge.

3.3.2 Finish. The ground and polished surfaces shall have a bright finish with a maximum of 63 roughness height rating (Arithmetical Average).

3.3.3 Blade length. Blade length shall be measured from the extremity of the cutting edge, to the point at which the width of the blade is reduced in forming the tang or socket.

3.4 Type I, chisels.

3.4.1 Class 1, framing, socket. Framing socket chisels shall consist essentially of a blade, socket, and handle.

3.4.1.1 Blade. The blades for class 1 chisels shall be either bevel or square edge, and shall conform to the requirements of 3.3.

3.4.1.1.1 Blade dimensions. Class 1 chisels shall have a minimum blade length of 8 inches, and shall be furnished in widths of 1/4, 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 7/8, 1, 1-1/4, 1-1/2, 1-3/4, and 2 inches.

3.4.1.2 Socket. The sockets shall have an inside taper accurately machined or forged to assure a firm and secure attachment of the handle to afford a maximum of resistance when subjected to blows delivered under service conditions.

3.4.1.3 Handle. Handles shall be of hardwood and shall conform to the requirements of 3.2.1. The handles shall be provided with a reinforcement ring on the striking end.

3.4.1.3.1 Ring. A steel or malleable-iron ring shall be of proper size and firmly secured on the outside diameter at the striking end of the handle to prevent chipping and splitting.

3.4.1.4 Type I, class 1 chisels shall be similar to figure 1.

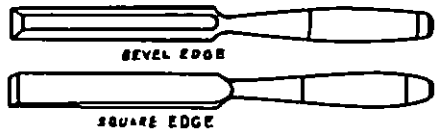


FIGURE 1. Type I, class 1, socket framing chisels.

3.4.2 Class 3, butt. Class 3 chisels shall consist essentially of a blade tang and bolster (see A of figure 2) or a blade and socket (see B of figure 2) and a plastic handle.

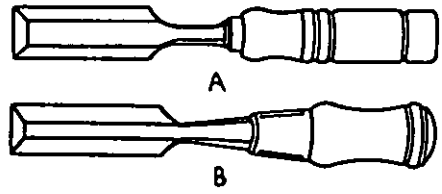


FIGURE 2. Type I, class 3, chisels, butt, bevel edge.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.2.1 Blade. Blades shall have both edges beveled the full length of the blade, and shall conform to the requirements of 3.3.

3.4.2.1.1 Blade dimensions. Blades shall have a minimum length of 2-1/2 inches and shall be furnished in widths of 1/4, 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 1, 1-1/4, 1-1/2, and 2 inches.

3.4.2.2 Tang and bolster or socket. A tang and bolster or socket shall be provided to secure the handle to the blade and be designed to afford a maximum amount of rigidity when subjected to blows delivered under service conditions. If a tang and bolster is provided it shall be constructed to furnish adequate support and assure a secure attachment of the handle. If a socket is provided, it shall have an accurately machined or forged inside taper to assure a secure attachment of the handle.

3.4.2.3 Plastic handle. Plastic handles shall be in accordance with 3.2.2.

3.4.2.4 Type I, class 3 chisels shall be similar to A or B of figure 2.

3.4.3 Class 4, firmer.

3.4.3.1 Style A, bevel edge, wood handle, socket. Class 4, style A chisels shall consist essentially of a blade, socket, and a hardwood handle having a leather cap.

3.4.3.2 Blade. The blade shall have both edges beveled the full length of the blade, and shall conform to the requirements of 3.3 and the dimensions of table I.

TABLE I. Type I, class 4, style A chisels, firmer

Length of blade			Width of blade
Nominal	Minimum	Maximum	
Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches
4-1/2	4-1/4	5-1/2	1/8, 1/4, 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 7/8, 1, 1-1/4, 1-1/2, 1-3/4, 2
6	5-3/4	6-3/4	1/8, 1/4, 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 7/8, 1, 1-1/4, 1-1/2, 1-3/4, 2

3.4.3.3 Socket. The socket shall be in accordance with 3.4.1.2.

3.4.3.4 Hardwood handle. Hardwood handles shall be in accordance with the requirements of 3.2.1. The striking end of the handle shall be provided with a leather cap.

3.4.3.4.1 Leather cap. The top end of wood handles shall be capped or tipped with at least three layers of high grade leather, totaling at least 3/8 inch, securely fastened to the striking end of the handle.

3.4.3.5 Type I, class 4, style A chisels shall be similar to figure 3.

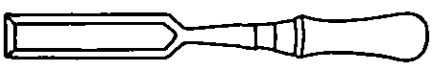


FIGURE 3. Type I, class 4, style A, chisels, firmer, bevel edge, wood handle, socket.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.3.6 Class 4, style C, firmer. Style C chisels shall consist essentially of a blade, blade tang and plastic handle.

3.4.3.7 Blade. Blades shall have both edges beveled the full length of the blade, and shall conform to the requirements of 3.3.

3.4.3.8 Blade dimensions. Blades shall have a minimum length of 4 inches and shall be furnished in widths of 1/4, 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 1, 1-1/4, and 1-1/2 inches.

3.4.3.9 Blade tang. Blade tangs shall be designed to extend at least 1-1/4 inches into the handle and be securely attached so that the blade tang will not become loose or turn in handle when subjected to blows delivered under service conditions.

3.4.3.10 Plastic handle. Plastic handles shall be in accordance with 3.2.2.

3.4.3.11 Type I, class 4, style C chisels shall be similar to figure 4.



FIGURE 4. Type I, class 4, style C, firmer chisels.

3.4.4 Class 8, paring, tanged. Paring tanged chisels shall consist essentially of a blade, tang, and handle.

3.4.4.1 Blade. Blades shall have both edges beveled the full length of the blade. The bevel edges shall be parallel with the flat surface of the blade and conform to the requirements of 3.3 and the dimensions of table II.

TABLE II. Type I, class 8, chisels, tanged paring

Length of blade (minimum)	Width of blade
Inches	Inches
5-3/4	1/8, 1/4
6-1/4	3/8
6-3/4	1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 7/8
7	1, 1-1/4, 1-1/2
7-1/2	1-3/4
7-3/4	2

3.4.4.2 Tang. Tangs shall be of a suitable size within the range for which the chisels are designed.

3.4.4.3 Handle. Handles shall be of hardwood provided with a metal ferrule and conform to the requirements of 3.2.1.

3.4.4.3.1 Ferrule. Ferrules shall be of either steel or brass and securely attached to the handle in such a manner as to hold the tang firmly and prevent the handle from splitting.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.4.4 Style A, straight shank. Straight shank chisels shall have the tang and handle parallel with the longitudinal surface of the blade and be similar to figure 5.

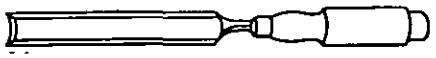


FIGURE 5. Type I, class 8, style A, chisels, tanged paring, straight shank.

3.4.5 Class 9, turning, tanged. Class 9 chisels shall consist essentially of a blade, a tang conforming to 3.4.4.2 and a handle and ferrule conforming to 3.4.4.3 and 3.4.4.3.1, respectively.

3.4.5.1 Blade. Blades shall be plain with square edges and conform to the requirements of 3.3 and the dimensions of table III.

TABLE III. Type I, class 9, tanged turning chisels

Length of blade (minimum)	Width of blade
Inches	Inches
6-3/4	1/8
7	1/4
7-1/2	1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 7/8
7-3/4	1
8	1-1/4, 1-1/2, 1-3/4, 2

3.4.5.2 Style A, square point. Square point chisels shall have a cutting edge ground square with the edges and flat surfaces of the blade, and be similar to figure 7.

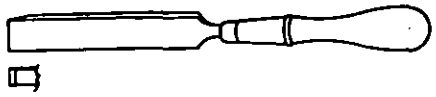


FIGURE 7. Type I, class 9, style A, chisels, tanged turning, square point.

3.4.5.3 Style B, round point. Round point chisels shall have a cutting edge ground with a radius equal to half the width of the blade, and be similar to figure 8.

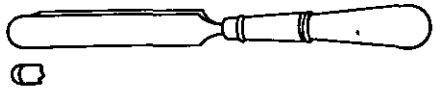


FIGURE 8. Type I, class 9, style D, chisels, tanged turning, round point.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.5.4 Style C, spear point. Spear point chisels shall have the cutting edge ground to not less than 70° nor more than 75° included angle, and shall be similar to figure 9.

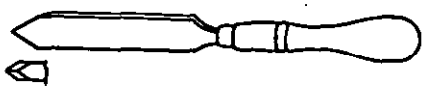


FIGURE 9. Type I, class 9, style C, chisels, tanged turning, spear point.

3.4.5.5 Style D, regular skew. Regular skew chisels shall have a blade ground on both sides to provide a cutting edge perpendicular to the shank with not less than 25° nor more than 30° included angle, and be similar to figure 10.

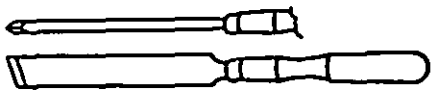


FIGURE 10. Type I, class 9, style D, chisels, tanged turning, regular skew.

3.5 Type II, gouges.

3.5.1 Class 1, firmer. Firmer gouges shall consist essentially of a blade and handle; and unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), either with socket or tang.

3.5.1.1 Blade. Blades shall be concave with a full sweep cutting edge and conform to the requirements specified in 3.3 and the dimensions of table IV.

TABLE IV. Type II, class 1, gouges, firmer

Style	Length of blade (minimum)1/	Width of blade
	Inches	Inches
A	5-1/2	1/8, 1/4, 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 7/8, 1, 1-1/4, 1-1/2, 2
B	5-1/2	1/8, 1/4, 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, 3/4, 7/8, 1, 1-1/4, 1-1/2, 2

1/ Blade length on tanged firmer gouge is measured from the bolster to the cutting edge.

3.5.1.2 Socket. Sockets, when specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), shall have an inside taper accurately machined or forged to assure a firm and secure attachment of the handle.

3.5.1.3 Tang. Tangs, when specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), shall be of a suitable size within the range for which the gouge is designed.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.1.4 Handle. Handles shall be of hardwood and conform to the requirements of 3.2.1. The striking end of the handle shall be either plain or provided with a leather cap. All handles furnished with tang gouges shall be provided with a metal ferrule.

3.5.1.4.1 Leather cap. Leather caps, when specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), shall conform to the requirements of 3.4.3.4.1.

3.5.1.4.2 Ferrule. Ferrules for handles furnished with tang gouges shall be of steel or brass and securely attached to the handle in such a manner as to hold the tang firmly and prevent the handle from splitting.

3.5.1.5 Style A, outside bevel. Outside bevel gouges shall have a cutting edge evenly ground on the convex portion of the blade and be similar to figure 12.

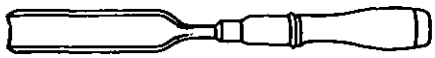


FIGURE 12. Type II, class 1, style A, gouges, firmer, outside bevel.

3.5.1.6 Style B, inside bevel. Inside bevel gouges shall have a cutting edge evenly ground on the concave portion of the blade, and be similar to figure 13.



FIGURE 13. Type II, class 1, style B, gouges, firmer, inside bevel.

3.5.2 Class 2, tanged turning. Class 2 gouges shall consist of a blade, tang, handle, and a ferrule conforming to 3.5.1.4.2.

3.5.2.1 Blade. Blades shall be concave with an evenly ground convex bevel cutting edge. The blades shall conform to the requirements of 3.3 and the dimensions of table V.

TABLE V. Type II, class 2, gouge, tanged turning

Length of blade (minimum)	Width of blade
Inches	Inches
6	1/4, 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, 3/4
7	7/8, 1
8	1-1/4, 1-1/2, 2

3.5.2.2 Tang. Tangs shall be of a suitable size within the range for which the gouge is designed.

3.5.2.3 Handle. Handles shall be of hardwood and conform to the requirements of 3.2.1. The handles shall be provided with a metal ferrule.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.2.4 Type II, class 2, gouges shall be similar to figure 14.



FIGURE 14. Type II, class 2, gouges, tanged turning.

3.6 Type III, socket slicks, oval back. Oval back socket slicks shall consist essentially of a blade socket and handle. Oval back slicks shall be ground and honed in such a manner that the cutting edge will be square with the flat surface of the blade.

3.6.1 Blade. Blades for type III slicks shall conform to the requirements of 3.3.

3.6.1.1 Blade dimensions. Type III slicks shall have a minimum blade length of 10 inches, and be furnished in a minimum width of 2-1/2 inches and a maximum width of 3-1/4 inches.

3.6.2 Socket. The sockets shall have an inside taper accurately machined or forged to assure a firm and secure attachment of the handle.

3.6.3 Handle. Handles shall be of hardwood and conform to the requirements of 3.2.1.

3.6.3.1 Type III oval back slicks shall be similar to figure 19.

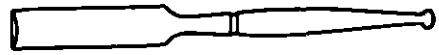


FIGURE 19. Type III, socket slicks, oval back.

3.7 Identification marking. Chisels, gouges, and slicks shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.8 Workmanship. The chisels, gouges, and slicks shall be free from rust, splintered or rough handles, loose blades or ferrules, or any imperfections which may affect their appearance, durability, or serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements, as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Sampling procedures. Sampling procedures shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Data for sampling shall be as stated in table I-A, defects are listed in table I-B.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE L-A. Sampling data

Category	Sample unit	Inspection level	Acceptable quality level (AQL) for major defectives	AQL for minor defectives	AQL expressed in terms of
Visual	One component each	II	4.0	6.5	Percent defective
Dimensional and testing	One component each	S-3	2.5	4.0	Percent defective
Destructive testing: Impact, heat distortion	One component each	S-2	2.5	4.0	Percent defective
Preparation for delivery	One shipping unit	II	2.5	4.0	Percent defective

TABLE L-B. Defects

Defect	Classification	
	Major	Minor
Type, class, style, or size not as specified.	X	
Material, coating, or marking not as specified.	X	
Roughness height value on cutting edge surfaces greater than specified.	X	
Roughness height value on other than cutting surfaces greater than specified.		X
Fractional dimensions out of tolerance by 5 percent of allowable dimension.	X	
Fractional dimensions out of tolerance by less than 5 percent of allowable dimensions.		X
Marking readable but not clear.		X
Any failure to conform to specified requirements that may affect usability.	X	
Any failure to conform to specified requirements that is not likely to affect usability.		X

4.3 Examination and testing.

4.3.1 Examination and testing of components.

4.3.1.1 Visual examination. An inspection lot shall consist of all like components submitted for inspection at one time. Each sample unit shall be examined for any nonconformance in design, material, finish, coating, construction, marking, and workmanship.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.1.2 Dimensional examination and testing. Each sample unit shall be tested to determine conformance with specified requirements. When specific test procedures are shown herein, these procedures shall be followed. When specific test procedures are not cited, all such procedures used shall have the approval of the Government.

4.3.2 Examination and testing of sets. An inspection lot shall consist of all sets submitted for inspection at one time. Examination and testing shall be accomplished by considering the inspection lot as being divided into sub-lots (i.e., a lot of 300 sets each containing 19 components and one box shall be examined as 20 sub-lots of 300 each.) A sub-lot shall consist of all like components, such as, like tools of a specific type, class, and size. Each sub-lot shall be inspected as individual components, and 4.2 and 4.3.1 will apply. Rejection of any sub-lot, based on the specified AQL, shall constitute rejection of the entire lot.

4.3.2 Quality conformance tests.

4.3.2.1 Testing of sample chisels, gouges, or slicks for hardness and cutting requirements. Each of the sample chisels, gouges, or slicks selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1 and 4.4.2 to verify compliance with the requirements of this specification. Any sample chisel, gouge, or slick which does not meet the requirements for either of these characteristics shall be rejected, and if the number of nonconforming chisels, gouges, or slicks in any sample exceeds the acceptance number in MIL-STD-105 for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4 Test procedures.

4.4.1 Hardness test. Each of the sample chisels, gouges, or slicks taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested on a Rockwell tester to determine conformance with 3.3.1. The reading shall be taken on the C scale using a diamond penetrator and employing a 150 kilogram load.

4.4.2 Cutting test.

4.4.2.1 Chisels, type I, classes 1, 3, and 4. Each of the chisels selected in accordance with 4.2 shall be required to make at least 3 complete cross-sectional cuts, progressively cutting 1/8 inch plus or minus 1/16 inch off the length of a 1.0 inch dowel of hard maple, ash, hickory, or birch having a moisture content of not more than 15 percent, while holding the chisel at any angle not more than 15° from the perpendicular to the dowel. Following this test, the full width of the chisel shall cut at least 2 shavings from a block of soft white pine. After application of the cutting tests, chisels shall be examined for any indications of flaws, cracks, undue wear, turning or breaking out of any part of the cutting edge or damage to the handle and be in conformance with the requirements of this specification.

4.4.2.2 Chisels, type I, class 8. Each of the chisels selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be required to cut a groove by hand pressure, and not by impact of not less than 3/8 inch deep and 12 inches long in hickory, ash, hard maple, or birch with a moisture content of not more than 15 percent. At the end of each cut, the wood chips shall be broken out by the pry of the chisel. After test, the chisels shall be examined for any indications of flaws, cracks, undue wear, turning, or breaking out of any part of the cutting edge or damage to the handle and be in conformance with the requirements of this specification.

4.4.2.3 Chisels, type I, class 9. A wood-turning lathe or other suitable machine for turning, having a speed of not less than 3,200 r.p.m. nor more than 3,600 r.p.m., shall be used in testing the ability of chisels selected in accordance with 4.2.3 to cut hard maple, or hard oak, with a moisture content of not more than 15 percent. The chisels shall then be subjected to at least ten individual cuts with each cut being the maximum capacity of the cutting edge relative to the size of the blade. After test, the chisels shall be examined for any indications of flaws, cracks, undue wear, turning, or breaking out of any part of the cutting edge or damage to the handle and be in conformance with the requirements of this specification.

4.4.2.4 Gouges, type II, class 1. Each gouge selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested in the same manner as specified in 4.4.2.1.

4.4.2.5 Gouges, type II, class 2. Each gouge selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested in the same manner as specified in 4.4.2.3.

4.4.2.6 Slicks, type III. Each of the slicks selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested in the same manner as specified in 4.4.2.2.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.3 Test procedure for plastic handle.

4.4.3.1 Heat distortion test. The handle of the chisels for test shall be completely immersed in boiling water at 212° F. for a period of two minutes. At the end of this period, the sample shall be removed from the water and shall show no significant signs of distortion or blistering.

4.4.4 Impact test at room temperature. The blade end of each chisel shall be mounted vertically in a vise affixed to the base of a suitable falling weight impact device. The blade cutting edge shall rest on a solid surface to insure that the blade does not move vertically in the vise. The weight shall be 15 pounds, cylindrical in shape, and shall be dropped through a piece of seamless tubing slightly larger than the diameter of the weight in order to insure that the full force of the falling weight will be acting normal to the striking surface. The chisel handle shall not break, crack, or significantly distort when the weight has been dropped a minimum of twenty times from the heights shown in table XI. In conducting this test, care should be taken that the impact energy shall not be expended in flexing of the blade or in driving the chisel cutting edge into the surface on which it rests. The blade shall be shortened or blunted if necessary, to insure a proper test.

TABLE XI. Impact test

Blade width	Height of drop of 15 pound weight for impact test
Inches	Inches
Under 1/2	8
1/2 thru 1	14
Over 1	18

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery. Unless otherwise specified, inspection to determine compliance with preparation for delivery requirements shall be accomplished in accordance with PPP-P-40. Inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with PPP-P-40. The level of preservation, packaging, and packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 Type I, classes 1, 3, 4, and 8 chisels are used for general purpose paring, cutting and chiseling of wooden blocks and shapes. Chisel handles are designed to withstand hammer blows.

6.1.2 Type I, class 9 chisels are generally used for cutting and finishing diameters of wooden shapes being revolved. Chisel handles are not designed to withstand hammer blows.

6.1.3 Type II gouges are generally used for cutting grooves, radii, patterns, or designs in wooden shapes being revolved or held stationary. Chisel handles are not designed to withstand hammer blows.

6.1.4 Type III slicks are generally used for heavy duty hand work on rough wood or logs. Chisel handles are not designed to withstand hammer blows.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, and style of chisels, gouges, and slicks required (see 1.2).
(c) Sizes (including length, width, and sweep, where applicable) of blades for chisels, gouges, and slicks required (see applicable table or paragraph).
(d) If blade widths are other than specified (see 3.3).
(e) Sockets when required for type II, class 1 (see 3.5.1.2).
(f) Tangs when required for type II, class 1 (see 3.5.1.3).
(g) Leather caps when required for type II, class 1 (see 3.5.1.4.1).
(h) Applicable levels of preservation and packaging (see section 5).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

No official DOD interest.

Preparing activity

GSA-FSS

U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE : 1974 O - 585-643/1332

Orders for this publication are to be placed with the General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 35 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.